

1/30/2017 - Campus Labs

<https://buffalo.campuslabs.com/faculty/FacultyReports/PrintableReports?courseSectionId=b2dbc681-b2d5-e511-80e>

10/13 Please comment on how effective the instructor was in teaching this course. - The instructor was very effective in explaining the course material, but not very effective in making a connection to the practical, how the lecture pertains to the programming aspect of the course. He is awesome, great personality, knowledgeable, and enthusiastic about the material. I believe some aspects of his class are too difficult though. Maybe I just did not prepare myself for the workload this semester, but I was under the impression a 4 credit class would reasonably take 8-12 hours of preparation outside of class per week. The required time to complete the assignments easily doubled or tripled that each week. I understand that in Geox's mind, an insane amount of time is not a requirement to completing the assignments, but when the only undergraduate groups I know that got full points before the deadlines admitted to spending hundreds of hours on them, it may as well be a requirement. In a situation like that, it is easy to feel like your performance is not being judged by your ability to grasp the concepts expected by the course syllabus, but by your willingness and ability to spend inordinate amounts of time on a single course. However, I do understand that Geox wants the course to be challenging and worth the effort. I can say that every hour put into this class is worth it in terms of personal growth and learning, just not everyone can afford to put in a lot of hours. Geox was flexible in allowing late submissions, and the curve (based on the midterm grades) was generous. Overall though I feel as though students would be more receptive to learning when more manageable goals are laid out before them. Georey Challen beyond surpasses the cumulative quality of the CSE faculty. His integration of humor within course material was profound; indicative of a humble, superior level of intelligence. I can't articulate how appreciative I am for the accessibility ease of lecture material. Some people are not fortunate enough to live the "full-time residential student" life, and it's extremely discouraging when attending to responsibilities results in falling behind/missing announcements in classes. TLDR: 10/10 would recommend would tell a friend. Dr. Challen (or gwa as he prefers) presented the material of the course in a way that was engaging, memorable, and funny (far more than a topic as dreadful as OS structural implementation has any right to be), which greatly helped on examinations. Enthusiastic and clear professor. Clearly spent time putting together course materials and designing infrastructure of course so that technical issues would not hold us back from working on assignments. His personal assistance was accurate without giving away answers. I felt like only smart questions should be asked, and I felt very insecure in asking dumb questions, this is a general feeling in the computer science department and I believe should be addressed. Some students who felt like they were behind, only got more behind, because of fear of scrutiny of the TA's, other students, and the Professor. There are 2 sides to Geox either he is in a great mood or he is in a bad mood. I think that he is generally a really nice guy but you do not want to get on his bad side. He made students feel very unwelcome during office hours, he seemed hostile and rude at times to students who were struggling but nice to others who had a better understanding. I was personally scared of interacting with him due to the way he treated students during office hours. Instructor assumes everyone has basic OS knowledge when teaching while that is not always true. The prof was really good. Had loads of fun. Very effective. Very effective. I liked how he used anecdotes throughout the lectures. I found no faults in this course other than it being difficult, but in a good way. Geox made me want to come to lecture because of his engaging teaching style. He is entertaining and crams tons of information into each lecture, but it is very easy to digest. The enthusiasm that Challen exhibited was amazing, I really felt bad when I missed every single class. I never felt bored in class. The assignments were well supported by the course staff, the opportunity to submit multiple times allowed us to experiment a lot. The 3rd assignment could've given less time for coremap and more time for other two parts. Also, the targets could've been released early so that people could've got more time to test. The lectures were among my favorite during my time at UB. But, the assignments were among my worst and most time consuming assignments. It is so hard for me...but the thing is installing OS was not easy. He is based on the slides that he made. And it is very effective! :) This is by far the best professor I've had at UB and really makes the course an enjoyable experience. He's super knowledgeable when it comes to course material, and you can tell he enjoys teaching it. The course is definitely hard, but his office hours are inviting and helpful, and he's always positive and funny. He's dedicated to the learning of his students as well as the entire CSE department. Geox was excellent in this course. Giving me the correct balance of well presented material, well defined goals, and solid guidance when seeking help in office hours. The instructor presented the material in an organized, easy-to-follow, and entertaining manner. Good, likes to say "right" a lot but he got better at it. Enthusiastic, likes to make jokes and funny during lecture. He was very effective. Maybe the only thing would be to give more of a background on the assignments and more direction in doing them. Given the size of the assignments, it seemed very difficult to have to rely on the TAs for instruction on how to do them even with a plethora of office hours. He taught well, and made class exciting. He was very good in his teachings. Also, he IS cute :) Challen was very effective and knowledgeable in his explanation of concepts. His enthusiasm showed in every class. He truly likes to teach Operating Systems. I enjoyed having Geox as a professor for this course! To me, Geox was very effective in teaching the conceptual aspects of the course, and I enjoyed attending the lectures. There was a disconnect in the difficulty of the conceptual aspects of the course and the programming aspects. This disconnect could have been alleviated by a more directed set of assignment descriptions, as stated earlier in my evaluation. This is my only "complaint", and it stems from the amount of struggling I did on the assignments. I have heard that CSE421/521 is a little above the level of many UB students REGARDLESS of who teaches it. I think there is a systemic problem here: either the 421/521 course itself, or the way UB's curriculum up to this point has (not) prepared us for this class. Everything being said, I would completely recommend Geox for any class. His enthusiasm, willingness to help, and the way that he makes the entire course (notes, lectures, recitations, etc.) available online show that he is dedicated to students! He is the best computer science teacher I have come across in my life so far! His enthusiasm for the topic was greatly reflected in his method of instruction; he explained topics quite thoroughly and made learning the material quite enjoyable. Prox GWA is really good and knows his stuff. His notes and lecture slides and videos really helped me learn the subject. :) Unapproachable. Very knowledgeable though. But expects you to already know too many things. He is awesome! I loved his teaching style, I was already interested in systems and OS, have worked in device drivers before. But he provided another angle to how to design systems and tradeoffs. He is one of the best teachers I have listened to the date. Great professor. He's a little intimidating but that just made me use every other possible resource before going for help.